

A View to View

Agent 001 seeks out the right monitor

Personal computers have become the hub of digital entertainment—there's no denying that. But it wasn't temptation enough to do away with the 15-inch monitor that had been sitting on my desk for the last 3 years. It was sufficient for all my word processing needs, and *Quake III* looked impressive enough at a resolution of 1024 x 768.

Everything was hunky dory till the day that photo-editing job invaded my world. Of course, I was glad to help, but the only thing that vexed me was the fact that I hadn't tried Photoshop on my PC—on my 15 inch monitor, to be precise. Macromedia Flash had not been quite friendly with my PC either, a few weeks back. Anyway, I decided to give it a go, and opened the PSD file.

Blink! All I could see was tool-boxes that clothed the image with a shroud of obscurity. Was it the resolution? Pumping that up only made the fonts squiggle, and the flicker exasperated my eyes. I thought I could survive until I reached a stage when I realised that I couldn't take the visual annihilation anymore.

Now, as that *Matrix* guy says, I started to believe, I needed a monitor upgrade... ASAP! And then began the battle of choices: should I buy an LCD, or a CRT? This battle was still on as

I headed straight towards a local vendor near my house, hoping he could help me out.

There he was, that buck-toothed guy, standing in front of his small shop, looking very much like a distorted

milega 'ell shee dee' nahi."

And then, as all roads lead to Lamington Road, I found myself there. The first dealer showed me an LG 700S 17-inch CRT, which according to him, was the best. He quoted a price of Rs 6,900, and offered me a discount of Rs 2,000 in exchange for my monitor. I asked

him if he had any 19-inch CRTs. He offered me an LG 900B for Rs 14,000, which is quite enticing, I must say. Then I asked him which one was better—an LCD, or a CRT? He gave me an interesting reply. "Aare ek LCD ke price mein teen CRT khareed sakthay ho, toh achha kya hoga?" *Touché!* He did have a

17-inch LCD Samsung monitor in stock that would deplete me, financially, by a whopping Rs 36,000. I gave him a sheepish smile, and slipped

into the next shop.

This wonderland was with the times, and the owner was quite tech-savvy too. He reckoned that LCDs offer sharper images, and take up very little space, but CRTs are much cheaper, and colour reproduction is richer on them. He offered me a 19-inch CRT from Samsung, and a 15-inch LCD from Philips, for Rs 14,400 and Rs 22,000 respectively, as an exchange offer. He also added that Samsung packed in a 3-year onsite warranty. Pronto, confusion waylaid my thoughts. Should I go for the 15-inch LCD that provides superior image quality, but lesser screen space, or the tried and tested 19-inch real estate?

Reason won over wonder, and I chose the 19-inch monster, for the enormous workspace it provides, which was the whole reason for looking for a display in the first place. At the end of it all, I had saved a mint cool Rs 6,000, and my eyes had found a view to fall for! ■

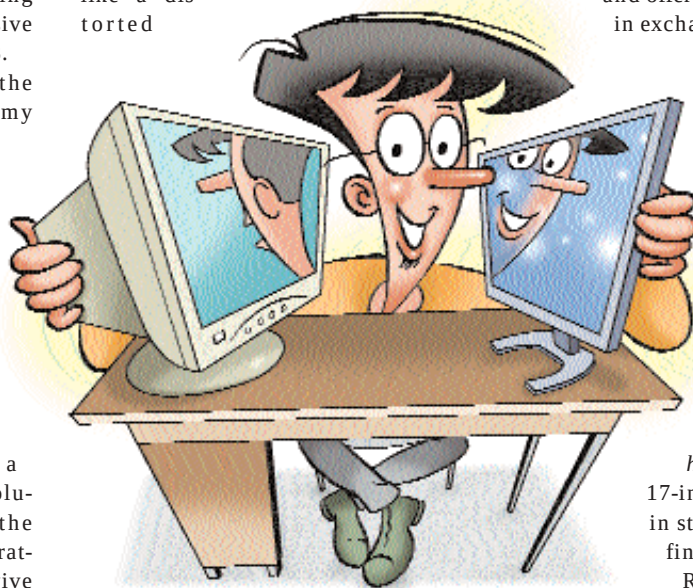


ILLUSTRATION: Mahesh Benkar

version of Scrooge. I told him of my upgrade dilemma, and I enquired which the best available was. He opined that Samsung was the best, and with a flourish, pointed towards the 763S 17-inch CRT monitor that was available for a cool 7,000 bucks. Boy! The price was impressive enough, but now, I was curious about the other players. With another grand gesture, he pointed to a good-looking LG Flatron E700S flat screen CRT monitor that would lighten my pockets by Rs 9,000. That seemed a fairly decent buy, but what about the LCDs? To my utter dismay, he said that he no longer stocked LCDs as they were too costly, and that nobody was interested in buying those.

I was not going to take that for an answer, since checking out one of those LCD beauties was something I was hell bent on doing. (I need to be impartial, right?) I went across to his local rival. Alas, the story was the same. "Digital



■ If you are planning to build a new PC, go for 17-inch monitors that are available within the range of Rs 6,000 to Rs 7,500.

■ Stay away from 14-inch monitors, as the dealer may be trying to sell an old piece, as they are not in production anymore.

■ Check if it an onsite warranty is supported, since transporting CRTs can be cumbersome.

■ Opt for an LCD if space constraints or aesthetics are your major deciding factors.